浙江大学 管理学院
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Google Glass: a great answer to the wrong question

Why it failed. How to bring it back.



Can Pamukcu · Design Thinking · 27 Oct 2026

WHAT HAPPENED

Great tech.
Bad reaction.



2012
Big launch

2013
Test version, $1,500

2014
People say “Glasshole”

Jan 2015
Google stops selling it

WHY IT FAILED · 1

Nobody asked for it.

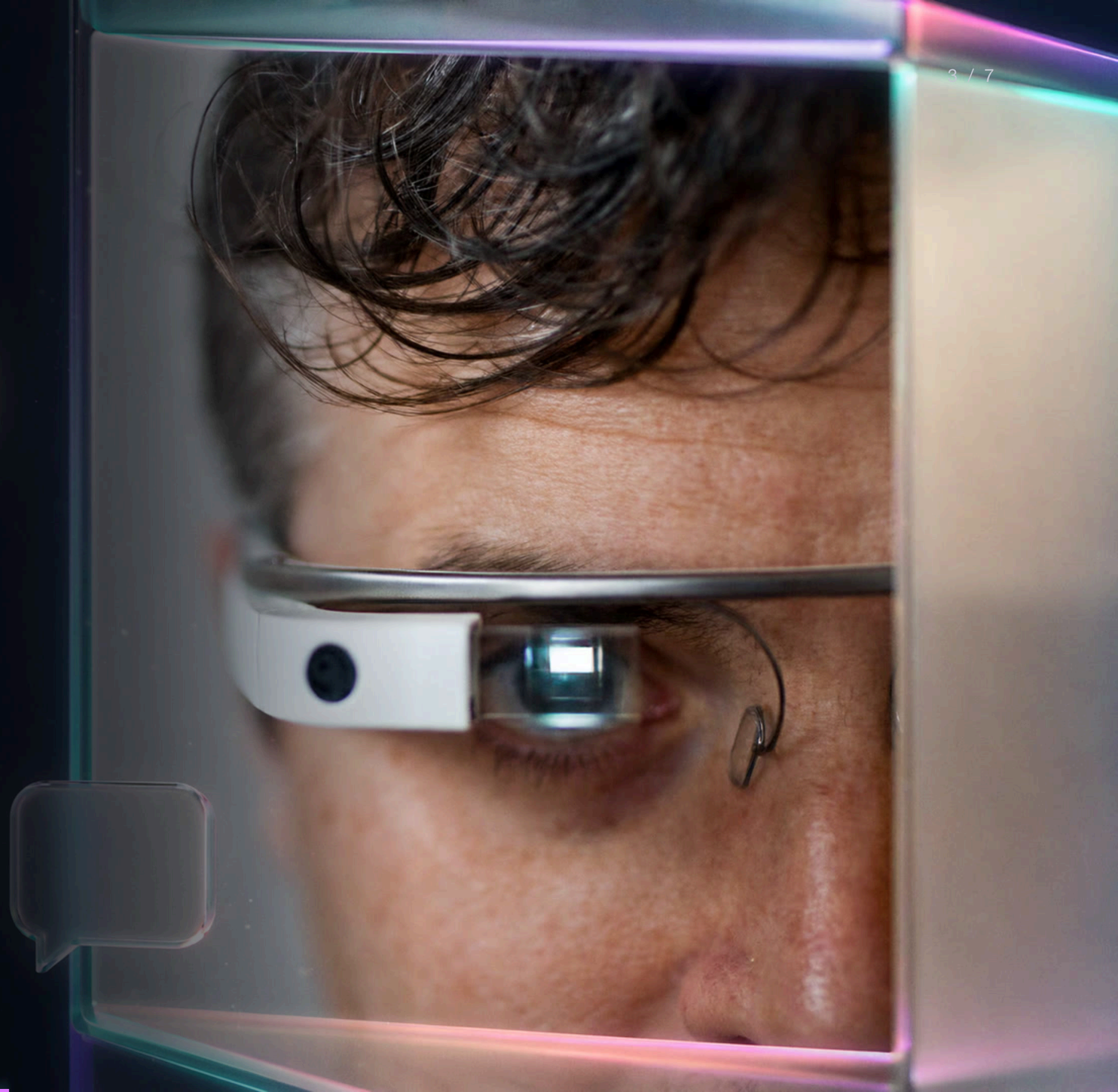
GOOGLE ASKED

“Can we put a computer on your face?”

NOBODY ASKED

“What do people need?”

Norman Griffin



WHY IT FAILED · 2

It worked for one person. Not for the room.



THE USER

Hands free, happy.

EVERYONE AROUND

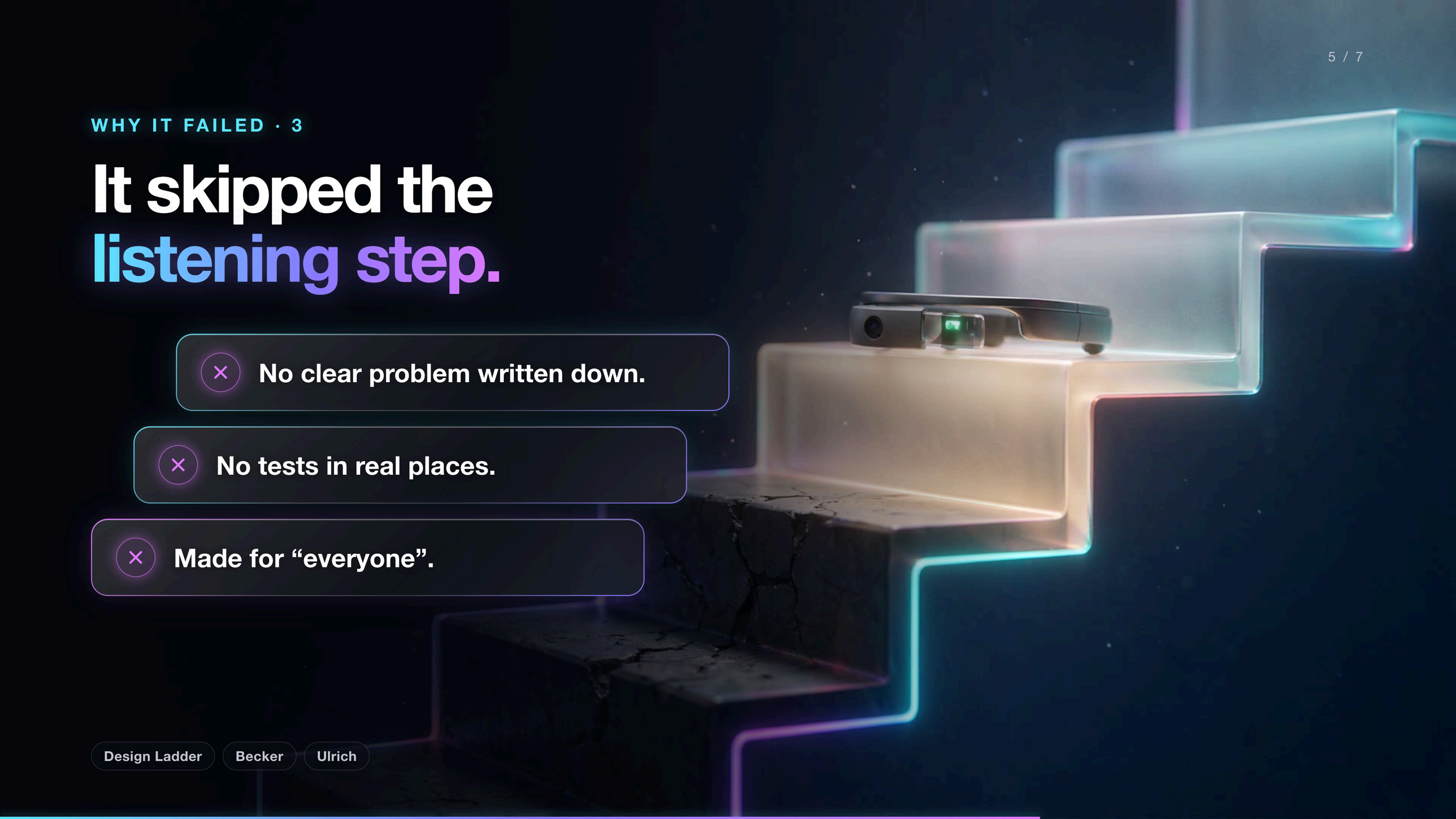
Watched. Not sure if it records.

Heufler Rams Papanek

WHY IT FAILED · 3

It skipped the listening step.

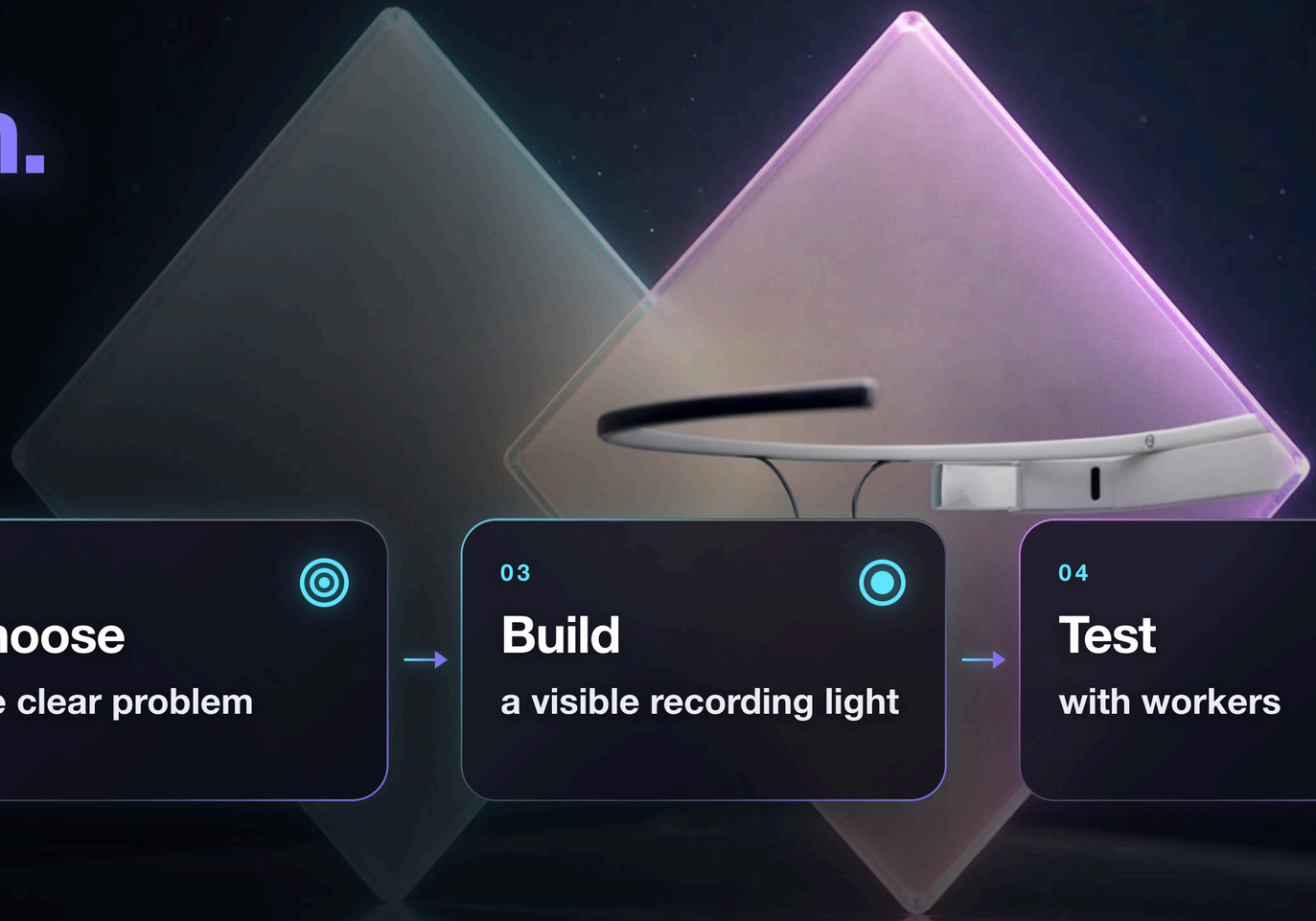
- ✕ No clear problem written down.
- ✕ No tests in real places.
- ✕ Made for “everyone”.



Design Ladder · Becker · Ulrich

THE FIX

Same tech.
New problem.
New room.



01
Listen
to everyone

→

02
Choose
one clear problem

→

03
Build
a visible recording light

→

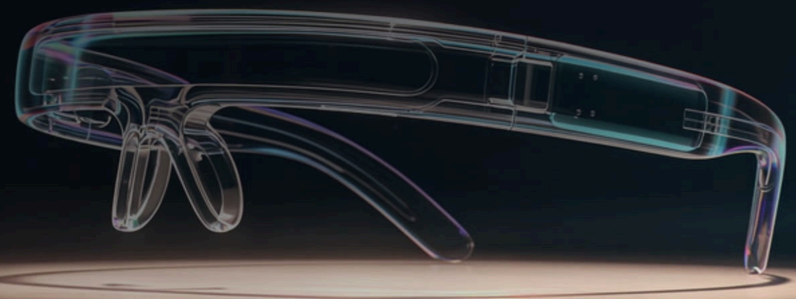
04
Test
with workers

Norman (Double Diamond)

Micheli

Before you ask what it does, ask: who is in the room?

Glass forgot the room. The room said no.



Thank you